

Modernize the datacenter, not just the hypervisor

The target platform should emerge from workload, operating-model and economic decisions - not from a predetermined product destination.

Start with the 5-10 year operating model

Decide which workloads should be VMs, containers, bare metal, SaaS or managed services - and where they should run.

Virtualization-centric

Best when the estate remains VM-heavy and near-term transformation should be minimized. Modernization may remain infrastructure-centric.

Kubernetes-centric

Best when new applications are predominantly containerized and platform engineering is already a strategic capability.

Unified VM + container

Move VMs first; modernize selected applications later. Valuable when reducing separate VM and container silos matters.

Mixed estate

Virtualization + Kubernetes + bare metal + cloud + SaaS can be a valid intentional target when workload needs differ.

The decision sequence

1 Disposition

Retain · Rehost · Replatform · Refactor · Replace · Retire



2 Execution

VM · Container · Bare metal · SaaS / managed app



3 Placement

Private DC · Colocation · Public cloud · Edge · Hybrid



4 Consumption

DIY · Enterprise-supported · Managed service

Three executive guardrails

Do not force transformation

Migration and application modernization do not have to happen at the same time.

Do not size by allocation

Use observed demand + growth + resilience headroom, not copied VM allocations.

Do not call a PoC production readiness

Validate backup, DR, upgrades, security, observability and Day-2 ownership.

Make the business case complete

A credible modernization program combines migration industrialization, transition economics, Day-2 readiness and evidence-based decision gates.

Five-year economics

CURRENT STATE

Software + hardware + storage + network + backup/DR + facilities + operations

TRANSITION

Discovery + platform build + migration + remediation + testing + training + parallel run

TARGET STATE

Platform + infrastructure/cloud + data protection + security + operations + support

5-year economics = transition + target run cost - avoided current-state cost

Savings become real only when legacy licenses, infrastructure, facilities or services can actually be retired.

Transformation roadmap

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Align

Trigger · outcomes · sponsorship · financial baseline

1

Discover & decide

Inventory · dependencies · disposition · platform strategy

2

Establish

Compute · network · storage · IAM · security · observability · DR

3

Pilot & industrialize

Representative pilots · patterns · measured throughput

4

Migrate in waves

Remediate · move · validate · cut over · decommission

5

Modernize selectively

Replatform/refactor where value justifies change

Six decision gates before scale

Problem understood

Estate understood

Workload-driven
platform

Credible Day-2
model

Complete business
case

Repeatable
migration factory